

(4) Berossus states that Nabonnedus, who came to the throne as the result of an insurrection, was king of Babylon when the city was captured in the seventeenth year of his reign by Cyrus who succeeded him.⁴³

(5) Alexander Polyhistor states that Nabodenus reigned seventeen years as the last Neo-Babylonian king and was succeeded by Cyrus.⁴⁴

(6) Claudius Ptolemy refers to Nabonadius as the last Neo-Babylonian king. Cyrus is mentioned as the next king.⁴⁵

(7) The information preserved by Abydenus is contained in the above statement of Megasthenes quoted by him.⁴⁶

(8) The fifth chapter of Daniel refers to Belshazzar as the last Neo-Babylonian king.⁴⁷ Nebuchadrezzar is mentioned as the father of Belshazzar.⁴⁸ There is no reference to Nabonidus. Darius the Mede is regarded as the successor of Belshazzar.⁴⁹

(9) The book of Baruch refers to Nabuchodonosor as king of Babylon and to Balthasar as his son.⁵⁰ There is no allusion to Nabonidus.

(10) Josephus states that Baltasar was called Naboandelus by the Babylonians and that he reigned seventeen years.⁵¹ He was followed by Darius, king of Media, who helped Cyrus to capture Babylon.⁵²

(11) The information contained in the quotations of Eusebius from ancient authorities has already been given. He adds little information of his own.⁵³

(12) According to Saint Jerome the last Neo-Babylonian king was Baltasar, whom he regards as the son of Labosordach. Baltasar was put to death by Darius, king of the Medes, and the Chaldaean empire was destroyed by Cyrus.⁵⁴

⁴³ See Josephus, *Contra Apionem* I, 20.

⁴⁴ The record of Alexander Polyhistor comes to us from the Armenian version of the Chronicle of Eusebius, with Latin translations in *CB* p. 22 and *CLP* col. 29.

⁴⁵ See references in note 15.

⁴⁶ Cf. note 41.

⁴⁷ Daniel 5: 1, 9, 30.

⁴⁸ Daniel 5: 2, 11, 18, 22. The form *Nebuchadnezzar* occurs in these passages.

⁴⁹ Daniel 6: 1, according to the Hebrew verse notation.

⁵⁰ Baruch 1: 11, 12.

⁵¹ Josephus, *Antiq. Jud.*, X, 11, 2.

⁵² Josephus, *ibid.*, X, 11, 4.

⁵³ For a brief interpretation of the historical situation see note 58.

⁵⁴ See note 33.

(13) Syncellus refers to Nabonadius as the last Neo-Babylonian king. He identifies Baltasar with Nireglesarus. Cyrus is mentioned as the next king of Babylon.⁵⁵

2. Attempts at Harmonizing Non-Cuneiform Data concerning Nabonidus and Belshazzar

Before the discovery and decipherment of cuneiform documents mentioning Nabonidus and Belshazzar scholars endeavored to explain the above non-cuneiform references to them in various ways, the general tendency being to leave undisturbed the position of Nabonidus as the last Neo-Babylonian king. Hence it was natural that divergence of critical theory should arise from attempts to provide a suitable historical rôle for Belshazzar. The following suppositions have been advanced:

(1) The name Belshazzar was a pure invention on the part of the writer of the fifth chapter of Daniel.⁵⁶

(2) Belshazzar was Evil-Merodach (*Amêl-Marduk*), and hence a son of Nebuchadrezzar.⁵⁷

(3) Belshazzar was a brother of Evil-Merodach, and hence a son of Nebuchadrezzar.⁵⁸

(4) Belshazzar was a son of Evil-Merodach, and hence a grandson of Nebuchadrezzar.⁵⁹

⁵⁵ See notes 34 and 35.

⁵⁶ This view was advanced before the discovery of the name *Bêl-šar-ušur* in cuneiform literature. See commentaries on Daniel by Von Lengerke, p. 204, and Hitzig, p. 75.

⁵⁷ This identification is supported by Zöckler in his commentary on Daniel, p. 34, Schaff's *Critical, Doctrinal and Homiletical Commentary*, XIII, where he enumerates a number of authorities in its favor, of whom Kranichfeld, Marsham, Niebuhr, Oehler, Röckerath and Zündel may be mentioned.

⁵⁸ See Sulpitius Severus, *Hist.* II, p. 6. Cf. Schoene, *Eusebii Chronicorum Libri Duo*, p. 95, for the following statement made by Eusebius: *Mortuo Nabochodonosor Babyloniorum rege suscepit imperium Evilmarodach cui successit frater eius Balthasar sub quo Daniel eam scribituram quae in pariete apparuerat interpretatus est significantem imperium Chaldaeorum in Medos et Persas transferendum.*

⁵⁹ See Quatremère in *Annales de la philosophie chrétienne*, (*Dict. de la Bible* II, p. 30, note), as quoted by Prince in *Mene, Mene, Tekel, Upharsin*. Quatremère advanced his hypothesis as an interpretation of Jeremiah 27: 7. Cf. Annii Viterbensis in *Antiquitatum Variarum Volumina XVII*, published in 1498, as quoted in *TSBA* I, p. 247 and p. 262, for the following list of Neo-Babylonian kings: *Nabugdonosor, annis 45; Amilinus Evilmerodach, annis 30; Filius hujus primus Ragassar, annis 3; Secundus Lab-Assardoch,*

(5) Belshazzar was Neriglissar (*Nergal-šar-ušur*), and hence a son-in-law of Nebuchadrezzar.⁶⁰

(6) Belshazzar was Laborosoarchod (*Lābāši-Marduk*), and hence a grandson of Nebuchadrezzar.⁶¹

(7) Belshazzar and Nabonidus were two different names of the last Neo-Babylonian king.⁶²

(8) Nabonidus was a son-in-law of Nebuchadrezzar. Therefore his son Belshazzar was a grandson of Nebuchadrezzar.⁶³

3. Scope of the Present Inquiry

The most tenable of the foregoing hypotheses will be revealed as the discussion proceeds. Fortunately we are dependent no longer upon pure supposition in dealing with the problem. There is now available a rich and valuable accumulation of Babylonian texts making specific reference to Nabonidus and Belshazzar. These new contemporaneous sources of information have thrown so much light upon the period under investigation that it is necessary to revise former critical and historical conclusions. It is now possible to prove

annis 6; Tertius Baltassar, annis 5. According to the theory of Annius, *Nergal-šar-ušur*, *Lābāši-Marduk*, and *Bēl-šar-ušur* were the first, second, and third sons of *Amēl-Marduk*.

⁶⁰ See Boscawen in *TSBA* VI, pp. 28, 29, 43, where the attempt is made to connect Belshazzar with *Marduk-šar-ušur*, misread for *Nergal-šar-ušur*. Syncellus associated Belshazzar with Neriglissar in his list of Neo-Babylonian kings *juxta ecclesiasticum computum*. See p. 10.

⁶¹ See Scaliger, *Isagogicorum chronologiae canonum libri tres* III, p. 190; Ebrard, *Comm. zur Offenbarung Johannis*, p. 45; Hofmann, *Die 70 Jahre*, p. 44. Prince, *op. cit.*, quotes these references.

⁶² As has already been indicated in note 26, Josephus thought that Baltasar (Belshazzar) and Naboandelus (Nabonidus) were the same person. Some commentators accepted this view of Josephus, e.g. Bertholdt, Bleek, Browne, Ewald, Hävernicks, Hengstenberg, Herzfeld, Kirms, and Michaelis. See Prince, *op. cit.*, p. 29, for references.

⁶³ George Rawlinson in his work entitled *Herodotus* I, p. 424, advanced this view, which may be summarized as follows: Nabonidus when he came to the throne would naturally want to make his position secure by allying himself with the family of Nebuchadrezzar. "He may have taken to wife Neriglissar's widow, or he may have married some other daughter of Nebuchadrezzar. Belshazzar may thus have been the grandson of Nebuchadrezzar on the mother's side." Rawlinson believed in the probability of such an alliance of Nabonidus with the house of Nebuchadrezzar because of the indications that Nabonidus had a son named after Nebuchadrezzar. See *KA* pp. 23ff and p. 55.

the verity of certain facts and episodes in the careers of Nabonidus and Belshazzar with considerable finality. Even where the premises will not permit assured inferences, great probability exists. The following topics indicate the scope of the inquiry which will be pursued:

- (1) The exalted and noble ancestry of Nabonidus.
- (2) The high position of Nabonidus before he came to the throne.
- (3) The prominence of Belshazzar before his father became king.
- (4) The manner of Nabonidus' accession to the throne.
- (5) The character of Belshazzar as a man of affairs.
- (6) The devotion of Belshazzar to the worship of the gods.
- (7) The association of Belshazzar with Nabonidus in the kingship.
- (8) The administrative power of Belshazzar in Babylonia during Nabonidus' absence in Arabia.
- (9) The events which took place in connection with the fall of Babylon.
- (10) The meaning of non-cuneiform allusions to Belshazzar.